

CHILD'S POSE

Balasana

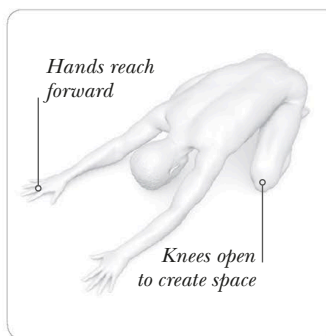
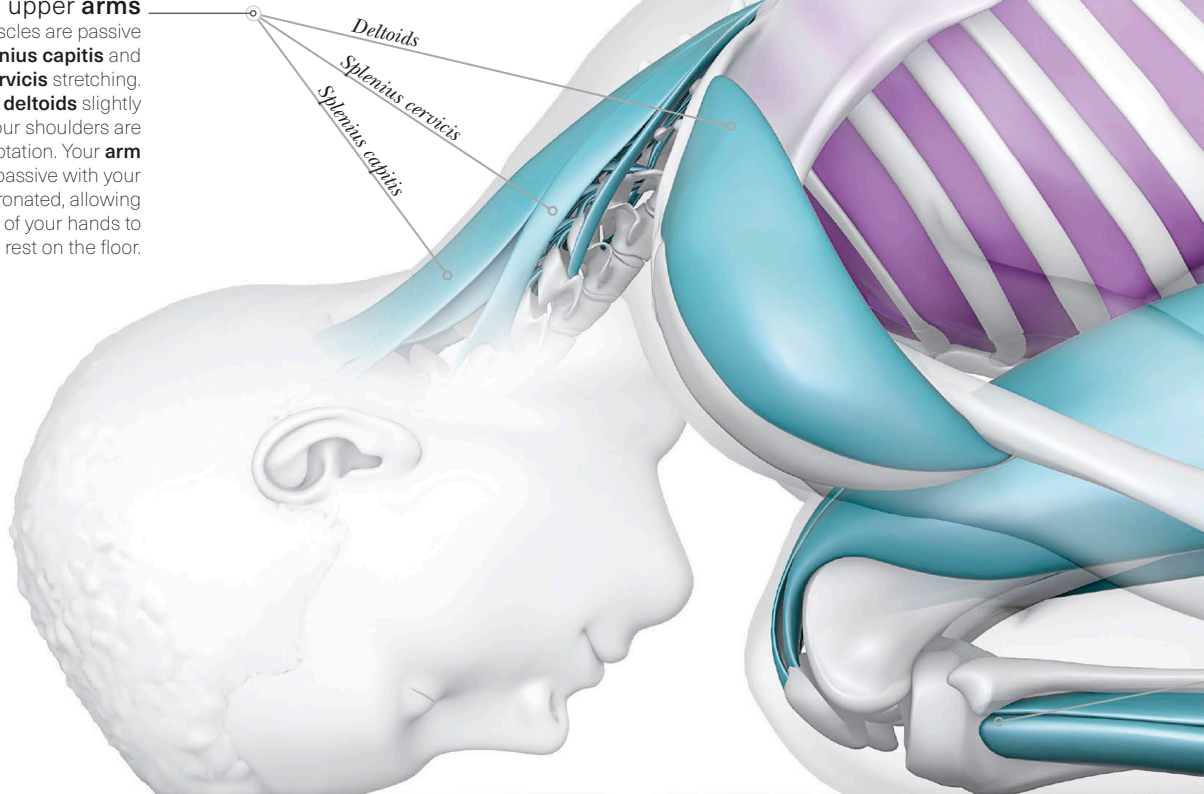
Reminiscent of the fetal position and with your weight supported by the floor, the restorative forward bend of Child's pose can be a deeply relaxing, restful posture for many. It provides a deep but gentle stretch for your back muscles, calming both body and mind.

THE BIG PICTURE

With as little muscle engagement as possible, your body releases down. In particular your back muscles, buttocks, and ankles stretch out. As you breathe deeply, the muscles in and around your ribcage dynamically engage and stretch with each breath.

Neck and upper arms

Your neck muscles are passive with your **splenius capitis** and **splenius cervicis** stretching. Your **posterior deltoids** slightly stretch while your shoulders are in internal rotation. Your **arm muscles** are passive with your forearms pronated, allowing the backs of your hands to rest on the floor.



VARIATION

Another option is to separate your knees and bring your hands forward. This allows more space for the torso and is a common resting pose during sequences such as sun salutations.